

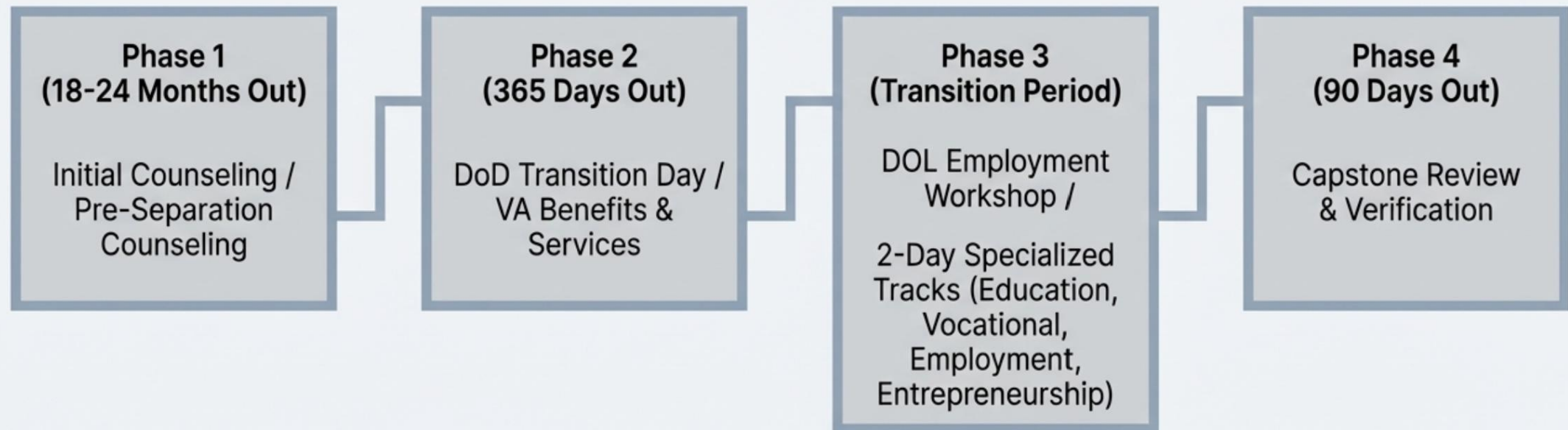
# The Future Is Now: A Governed AI Idea for Empowering Military Learner Mobility and Career Alignment

**For Research and Downloads**

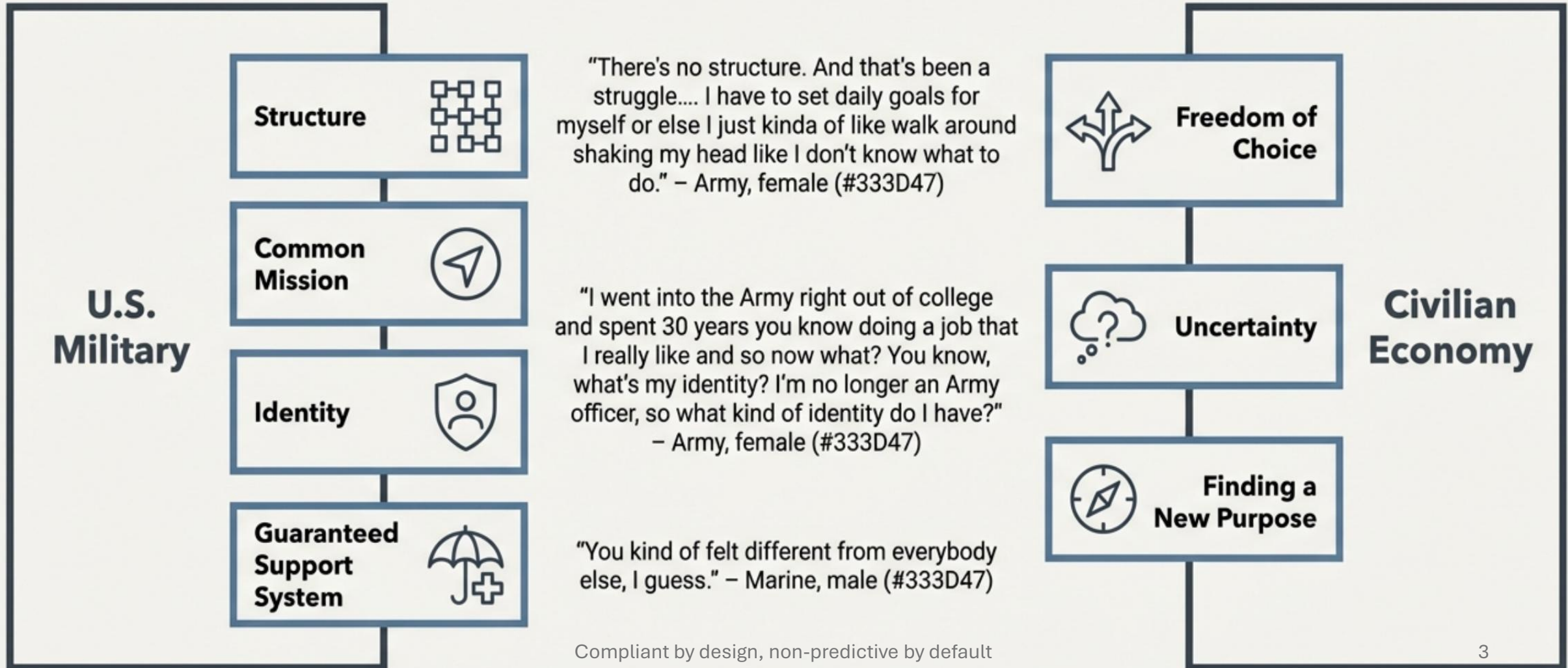
**[robertmccoyprojects.com](https://robertmccoyprojects.com)**

# System Architecture: The Mandated Transition Pathway (TAP)

The Transition Assistance Program (TAP) provides the core structured pathway for service members moving to civilian life. The process is designed as a multi-stage timeline, beginning up to two years pre-separation, and involving mandatory briefings and individualized tracks across multiple agencies (DoD, VA, DOL).

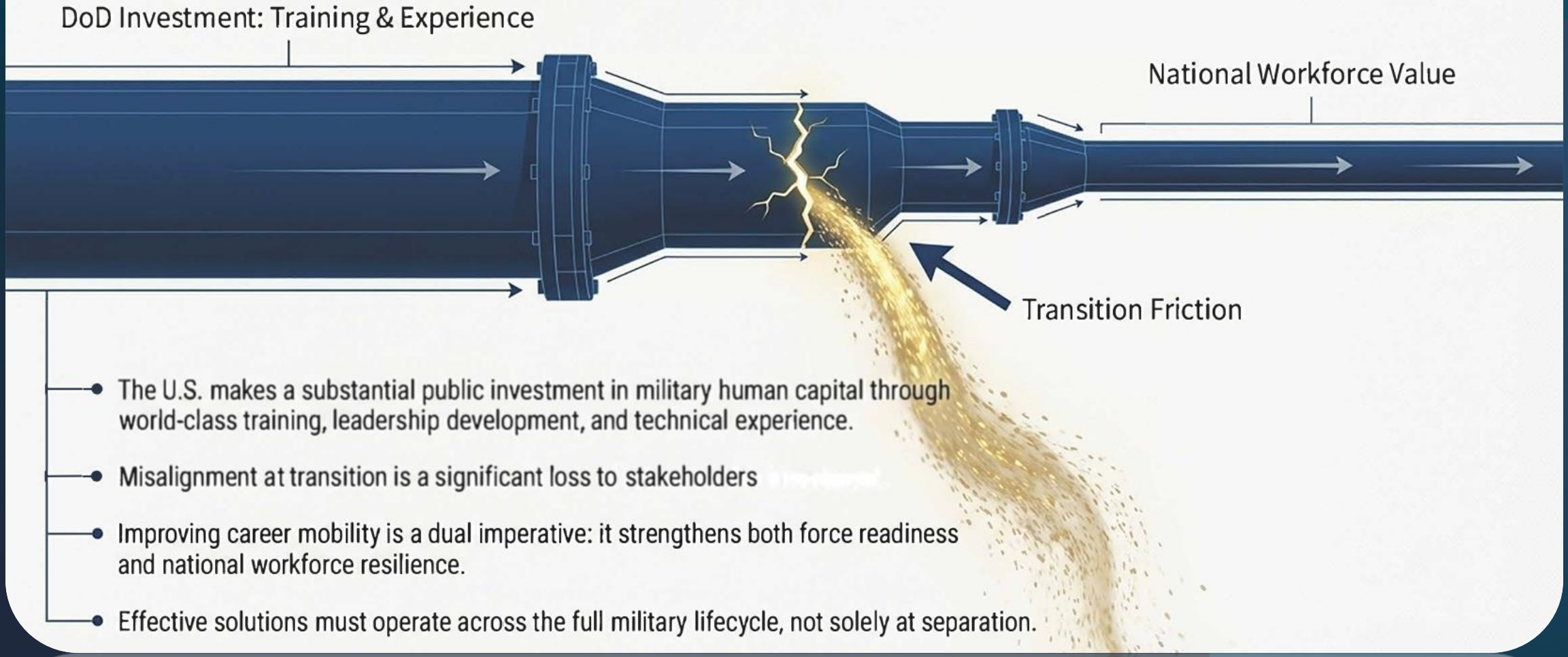


# The Transition is a Fundamental Disconnect of Structure, Identity, and Purpose



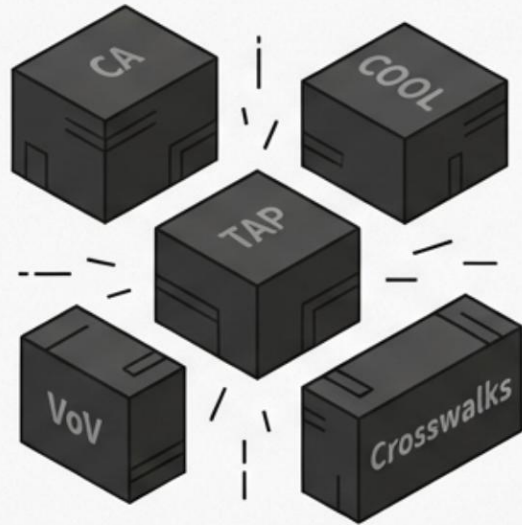


# MISALIGNMENT REPRESENTS A DIRECT LOSS ON OUR NATIONAL HUMAN CAPITAL INVESTMENT



Effective solutions must operate across the full military lifecycle, not solely at separation.

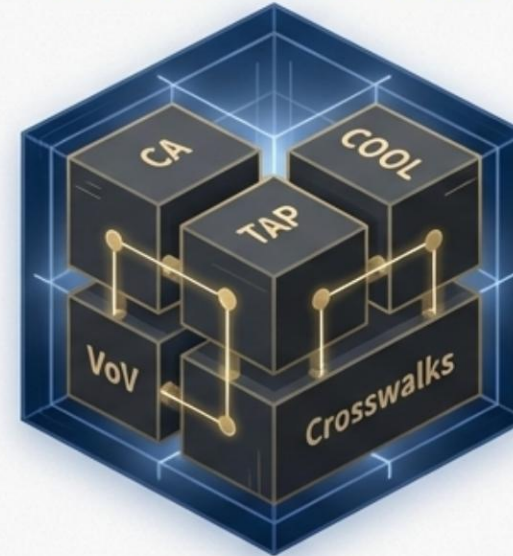
# WE HAVE A SYSTEMS PROBLEM. WE NEED A SYSTEMS SOLUTION.



**FRAGMENTATION**



**Governance Framework**



**INTEGRATION**

- **The Challenge:** A systemic misalignment between military investment and civilian workforce value, driven by policy friction and a persistent translation gap.
- **The Consequence:** Significant loss of national ROI and wage regression for our most valuable human capital.
- **The Need:** A shift from fragmented programs to an integrated, governed framework that coordinates policy, technology, and advising.

# Focus Areas: Military Learner Career Mobility

Five critical dimensions within the governance framework addressing systemic challenges in military-to-civilian career transition

[Download Focus Area Brief](#)[View Full Framework](#)

## OVERVIEW

### Track 1 Focus Areas

Each focus area represents a distinct policy challenge and operational bottleneck in the current military career transition ecosystem. These areas are interconnected and collectively define the scope of the Career Mobility Governance Framework.

**01**

Military Learner Career  
Mobility

**02**

Empowerment & Stackable  
Pathways

**03**

Career-Aligned Advising

**04**

Translation of Military  
Experience

**05**

Veteran & Servicemember  
Voice



# Military Learner Career Mobility

### Key Challenge

Longitudinal planning infrastructure gap between education investment and career outcomes

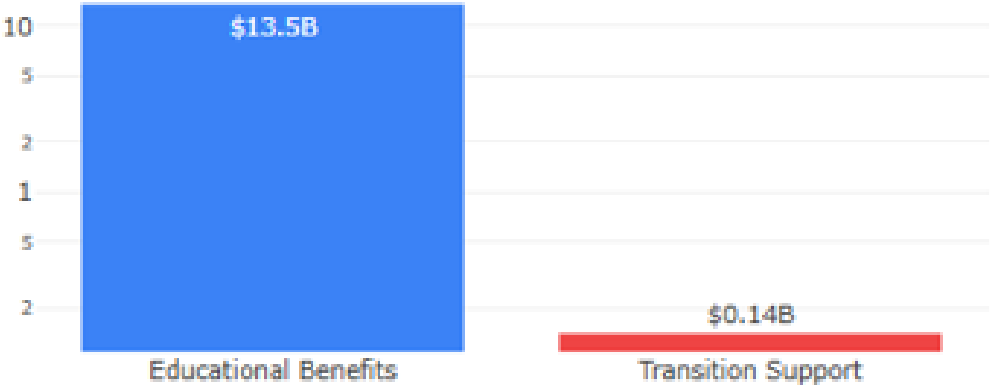
### Problem Statement

Military learner career mobility failures are driven less by insufficient education participation than by the absence of longitudinal planning and translation infrastructure connecting in-service decisions to post-service labor-market outcomes.

“ Citation: Kleykamp et al., 2024; McKinsey & Company, 2022; Barr et al., 2021

## Funding Comparison

Educational vs Transition Funding

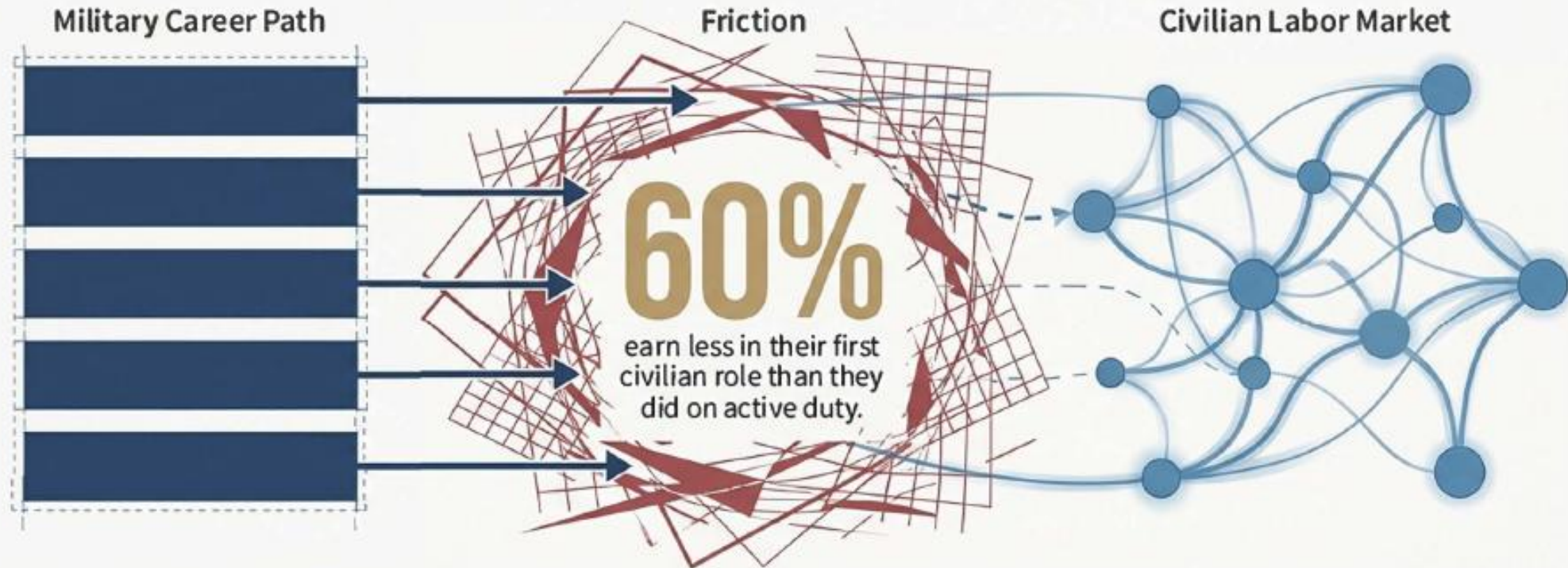


### Veterans Transition Funding Programs

Comprehensive breakdown of education and workforce programs

| Program                                                                                                                                          | Purpose                                                             | Funding    | Notes                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>Post-9/11 GI Bill (PGIB)</b><br>Primary education benefit | Tuition, fees, housing allowance, books                             | \$10.7B    | Direct-to-institution payments; most generous subsidy in U.S. history |
|  <b>VR&amp;E</b><br>Vocational Rehabilitation                 | Training and education for disabled veterans                        | \$1.8B     | Includes stipends and support services                                |
|  <b>DoD Tuition Assistance (TA)</b><br>Active duty support  | Active-duty tuition & credential funding                            | \$600M     | Allows up to ~\$4,500 per year per service member                     |
|  <b>DEA</b><br>Dependents' Education                        | Education for spouses/dependents                                    | \$400M     | Smaller in scale but part of the "Big Four"                           |
| <b>Subtotal "Big Four"</b>                                                                                                                       |                                                                     | \$13.5B    | ~95% of transition funding                                            |
|  <b>TAP</b><br>Transition Assistance                        | Mandatory separation counseling, employment prep, skill translation | \$140M     | Serves all separating service members                                 |
|  <b>Other workforce alignment efforts</b><br>Pilot programs | Apprenticeships, credential crosswalks, employer engagement         | Negligible | Limited pilot programs, often underfunded                             |

# MILITARY CAREER MOBILITY IS A SYSTEMS COORDINATION PROBLEM



Military career paths are episodic and highly structured; civilian labor markets reward continuity and credential signaling. Each year, 150,000–200,000 service members transition, facing a structural disconnect.

The consequence: Over half experience initial wage regression, a loss of earning power despite immense experience.

Research identifies structural friction—not skill deficiency—as the primary barrier.

The consequence: Over half experience initial wage regression, a loss of earning power despite immense experience.

Each year, 150,000–200,000 service members transition, facing a structural disconnect.



## Empowerment & Stackable Pathways

### Key Challenge

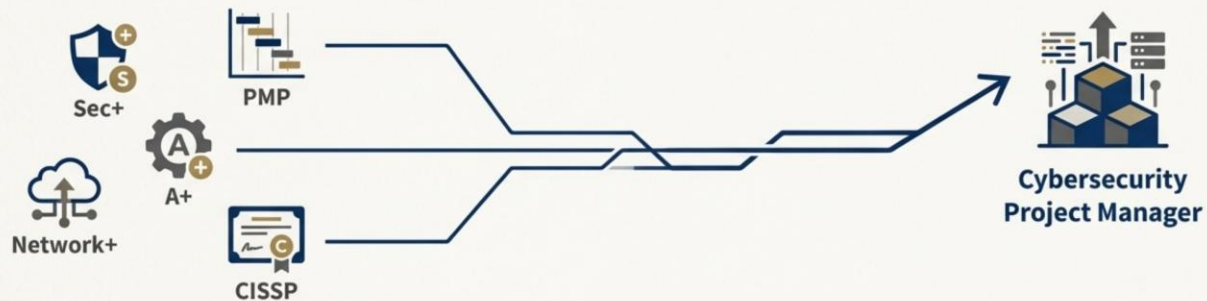
Credential sequencing without transparent constraint awareness or labor market signaling

### Problem Statement

Stackable credentials function as empowerment mechanisms only when learners can evaluate sequencing decisions within a transparent, constraint-aware planning context aligned to labor-market signaling over time.

“ Citation: CAEL, 2018; IVMF, 2019; Digital Education Council, 2025

## STACKABLE CREDENTIALS SHOULD FUNCTION AS LABOR-MARKET CURRENCY



- Stackable, portable credentials translate military experience into employer-recognized value.
- Programs like Credentialing Assistance (CA) and COOL were designed to fund specialization, not baseline competencies required for a job.
- Research confirms that modular credential pathways improve employment alignment and reduce wage regression when intentionally sequenced.
- Without clear sequencing, credentials become fragmented assets rather than a cumulative career narrative.

03

FOCUS AREA

## Career-Aligned Advising

### Key Challenge

Human advising capacity cannot scale to heterogeneous, frequently transitioning population

### Problem Statement

Human advising alone cannot scale to provide continuous, evidence-based career guidance across a population characterized by frequent transitions, heterogeneous constraints, and fragmented policy regimes.

“ Citation: IVMF, 2019; Kleykamp et al., 2024; Ahmed et al., 2024

### Evidence Base

Peer-reviewed research documenting advising capacity constraints



#### IVMF (2019): Transition Support Infrastructure

Documented systematic gaps in continuous career guidance availability, particularly for servicemembers in remote locations or during deployment cycles. Found that appointment-based models failed to meet learner needs at critical decision points.

Source: Institute for Veterans and Military Families, 2019



#### Kleykamp et al. (2024): Longitudinal Planning Gaps

Identified absence of continuous planning infrastructure as primary driver of career mobility failures. Demonstrated that education participation alone is insufficient without ongoing guidance connecting in-service decisions to post-service outcomes.

Source: RAND Corporation, Kleykamp et al., 2024



#### Ahmed et al. (2024): Evidence-Based Guidance Requirements

Analyzed information requirements for effective career advising across heterogeneous military populations. Found that human advisors require infrastructure support to maintain currency across labor markets, credential landscapes, and policy frameworks.

Source: Ahmed et al., 2024

# Translation of Military Experience

## Key Challenge

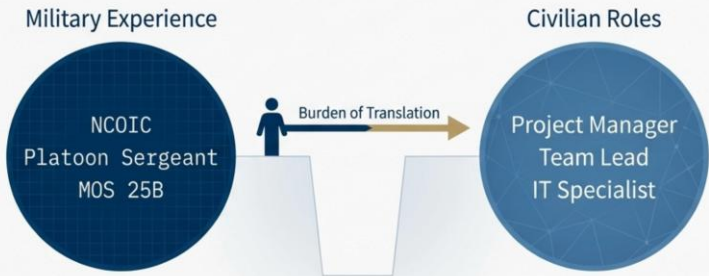
Equivalency frameworks exist but remain inaccessible at individual decision points

## Problem Statement

Failures in translating military experience into civilian workforce value arise from fragmentation, inconsistent application, and inaccessibility of equivalency frameworks at the point of individual decision-making.

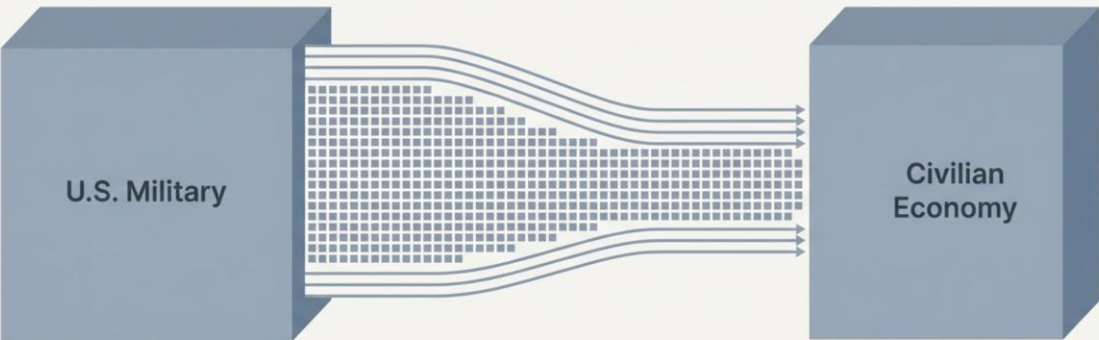
“ Citation: CAEL, 2018; ACE, n.d.; RAND, 2022

## THE TRANSLATION GAP: THE BOTTLENECK TO OPPORTUNITY



Military experience is frequently undervalued because standardized translation mechanisms are lacking. Civilian employers rely on credentials and job titles as shorthand for capability. This places the undue burden of translation on the individual service member during a high-stress period. Translation failures contribute directly to underemployment and wage loss.

## 200,000 Service Members Transition to Civilian Life Annually



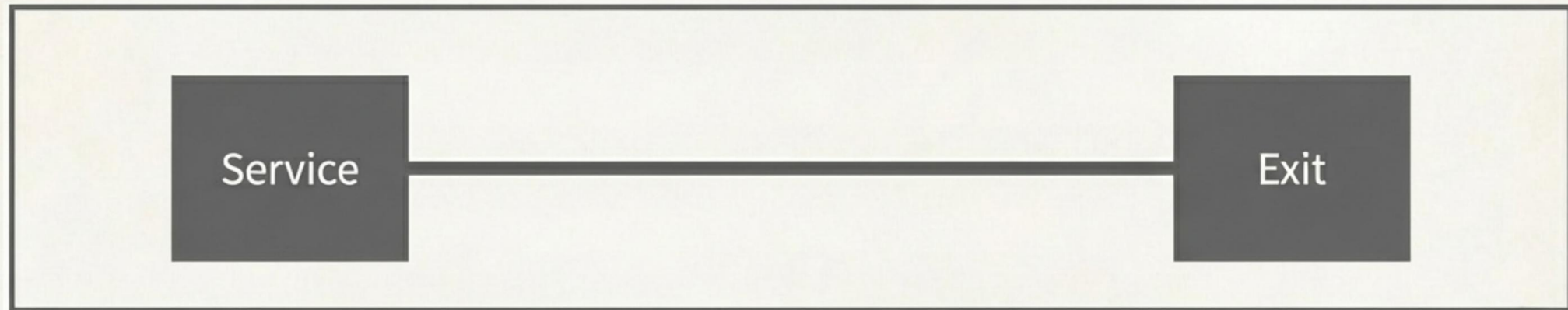
Each year, about 200,000 U.S. service members leave active duty and transition to civilian employment.

This recurring event represents a significant transfer of specialized skills, experience, and leadership potential into the national workforce.

The efficiency and success of this transition has direct policy and economic implications.



# The Prevailing Model: Transition as a Singular Event



- We currently frame transition as a single exit point.
- This view obscures the cumulative impact of decisions made over a full career.
- It treats a complex journey as a simple administrative step.

05

FOCUS AREA

## Veteran & Servicemember Voice

### Key Challenge

Learner-reported friction remains anecdotal, unusable for institutional learning

### Problem Statement

Without mechanisms that aggregate learner-reported planning friction at scale, transition failures remain anecdotal and unusable for institutional learning or policy reform.

“ Citation: IVMF, 2019; Kleykamp et al., 2024; Bradbard et al., 2024

### Types of Learner-Reported Friction

#### Constraint Discovery Failures

"I didn't know I couldn't use TA and GI Bill simultaneously until after I enrolled"

#### Translation Gaps

"My military training didn't count for any credit at this institution despite ACE recommendations"

#### Advising Inconsistency

"Different advisors gave me conflicting information about benefit eligibility"

#### Labor Market Misalignment

"This credential doesn't have the market value I was told it would"

#### Pathway Opacity

"I can't see how my current choices affect future options"

## What the evidence shows

- High education participation does not translate reliably into civilian career alignment. *(Education Goals not in line with Desired Career)*
- Underemployment persists despite strong skills and motivation. *(Skill translation is weak and Not Fully Recognized)*
- Career decisions are made without visibility into timing, sequencing, and policy constraints. *(Time spent wisely)*
- Translation failures occur at the point where skills must become recognized signals. *(Issue Industry Recognized Certs)*

## What is missing

- No longitudinal view of how in-service decisions affect post-service outcomes (Best Use of Time)
- No neutral way to test education and credential choices before benefits are spent (Sandbox)
- No mechanism to aggregate learner friction into usable institutional evidence (Backend Data Collection)
- No integration layer connecting programs, policies, and labor-market signals (Ongoing Transparent Analysis)

*The friction is not skill, effort, or motivation — it is visibility, timing, and sequencing under constraints.*

*(Cf. Seelig, 2025; RAND; IVMP)*

*Compliant by design, non-predictive by default*



# What If Career Planning Were Continuous?

- What if career responsibility remained with the service member—**supported, not delegated, by the system?**
- What if every service member had **continuous access to informed guidance**, not episodic counseling?
- What if career options both “military and civilian” were **visible and comparable from day one of service?**
- What if planning decisions were **revisited regularly**, informed by policy, labor markets, and personal constraints?

Agency is strongest when individuals are informed, supported, and empowered by transparent systems

# A Human-Centered AI Governance Framework for Military Career Transitions

## Layer 1: Individual Agency

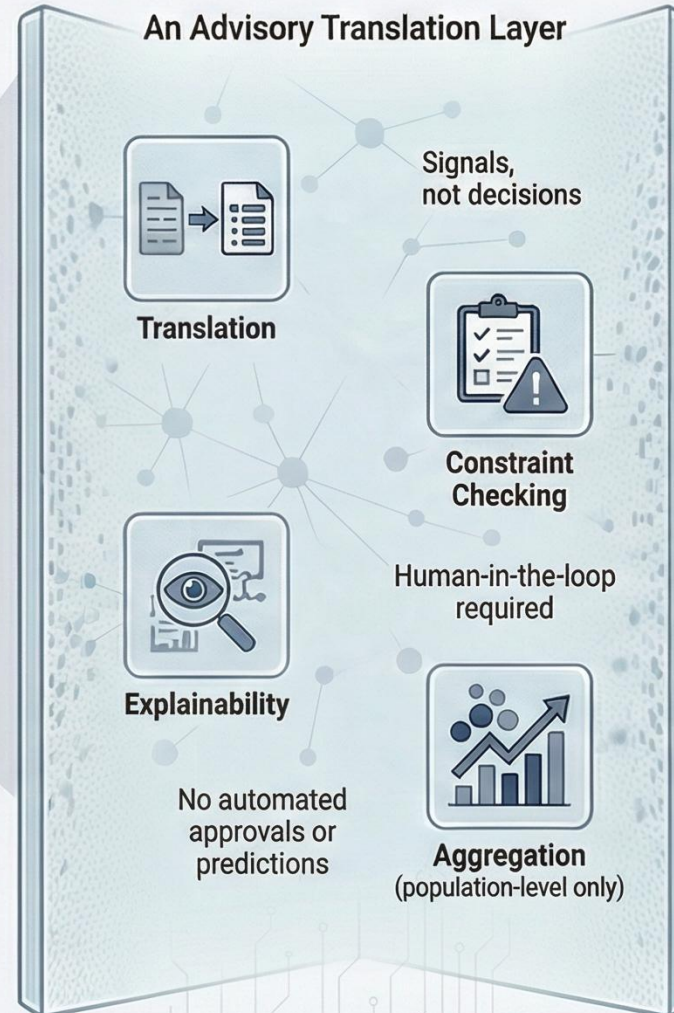
The Individual is the Sole Source of Action



The service member actively initiates the process, providing all necessary inputs based on their personal circumstances and ambitions. This layer is the origin point of all data flow.

## Layer 2: AI Mediation

An Advisory Translation Layer



## Layer 3: Institutional Stewardship and Policy

Decision Authority Resides with Humans



This layer is where all formal decisions are made by designated human roles, who use the AI's signals as one of many inputs





# THE CAREER MOBILITY GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK (CMGF)

The CMGF is the technical and policy system designed to address these challenges.  
Its architecture is built to:

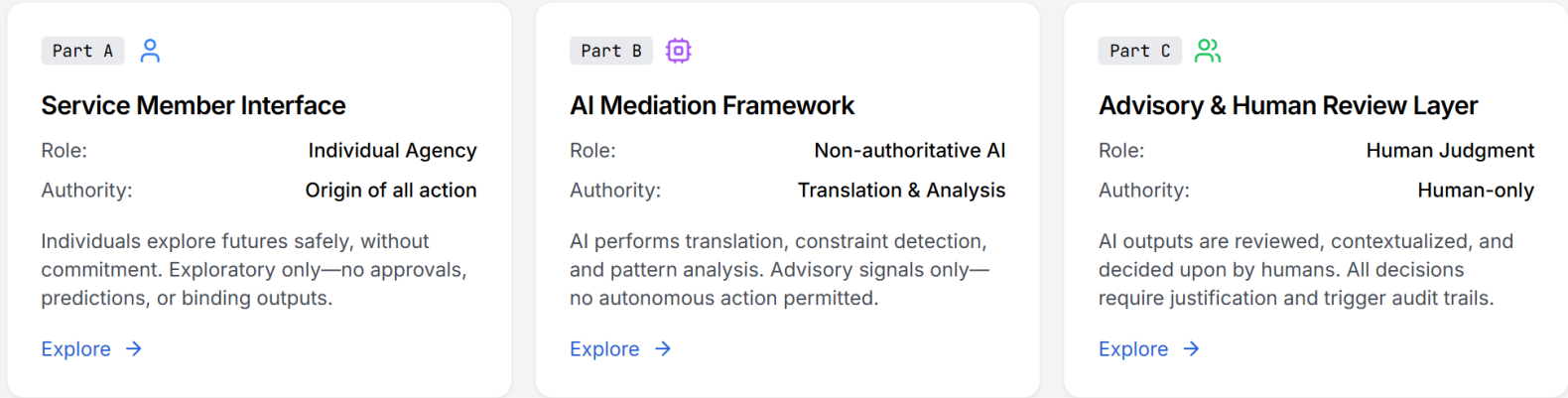
- **Integrate** disparate data and programs.
- **Translate** military experience into civilian value.
- **Empower** advisors and learners with planning tools.
- **Govern** the system through continuous, data-informed learning.



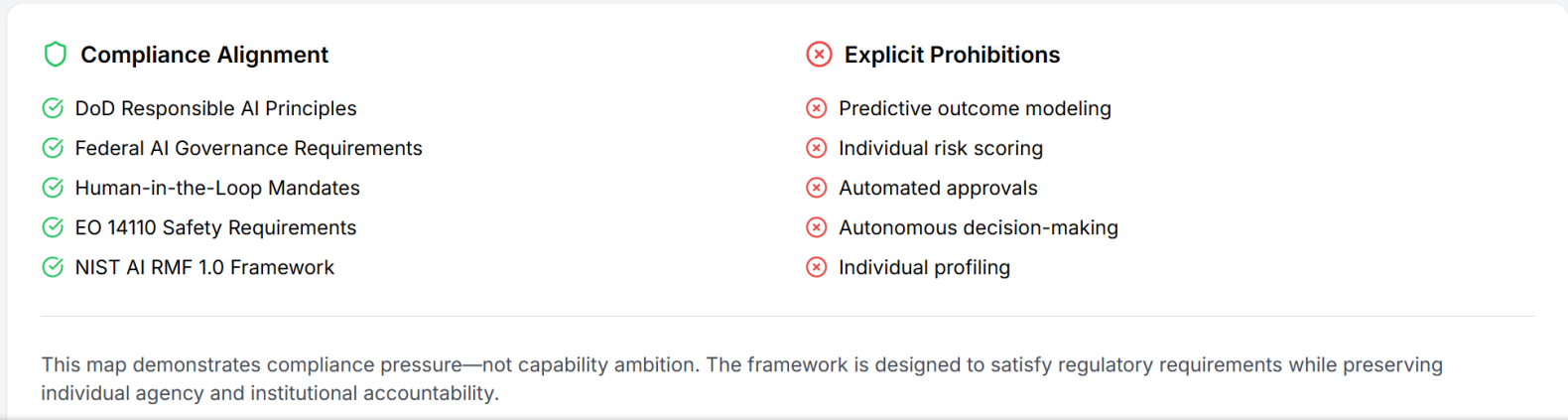
# Framework Walkthrough

The CMGF operates through three interconnected layers, each with distinct roles and authority boundaries. This architecture ensures human judgment is preserved at every decision point.

## THREE-PART ARCHITECTURE



## SYSTEM RIGOR MAP



# Service Member Interface

Role: Individual Agency Authority: Origin of all action

This layer enables individuals to explore possible futures safely, without commitment. All interactions are exploratory—no approvals, no predictions, no binding outputs.

**Interface Rules**

All exploration is non-binding  
No automated approvals or decisions  
No predictive success modeling  
Individual controls all data and exploration

## INTERFACE PAGES



Exploratory

### User Profile Setup

Service members establish their baseline profile including service history, current credentials, and transition timeline.

[View Interface Demo](#)



Exploratory

### Goals and Constraints Input

Capture individual aspirations, geographic preferences, family considerations, and timeline requirements.

[View Interface Demo](#)



Exploratory

### Credentials Assessment

Review and translate military credentials to civilian equivalencies. Identify potential recognition gaps.

[View Interface Demo](#)



Exploratory

### Career and Education Planner

Explore education pathways and career trajectories without commitment. Map potential routes to goals.

[View Interface Demo](#)



Exploratory

### Scenario Exploration Tools

Generate hypothetical pathways based on stated goals and constraints. All scenarios are non-binding.

[View Interface Demo](#)



Exploratory

### Scenario Comparison

Compare multiple pathways side-by-side. Evaluate trade-offs across time, cost, and goal alignment.

[View Interface Demo](#)



Exploratory

### Advisory Insights

Receive contextualized information about pathways. All insights are informational—never prescriptive.

[View Interface Demo](#)



Exploratory

### Action Buttons and Resources

Access to human advisors, official resources, and next steps. All actions initiated by the service member.

[View Interface Demo](#)



Exploratory

### Contact and Support

Direct connections to human advisors and support resources. Technology supports—never replaces—human guidance.

[View Interface Demo](#)

# The Credential & Education Timeline Planner: A Dashboard for Military Career Strategy

## AI Literacy Status Panel



**AI is Advisory, Not Authoritative:**  
The system uses AI for governed explanations, not prescriptive recommendations.

## Voice of the Veteran (VoV) Integration

User input via interactive sliders:

Financial Stress Level

low high

Confidence in Plan

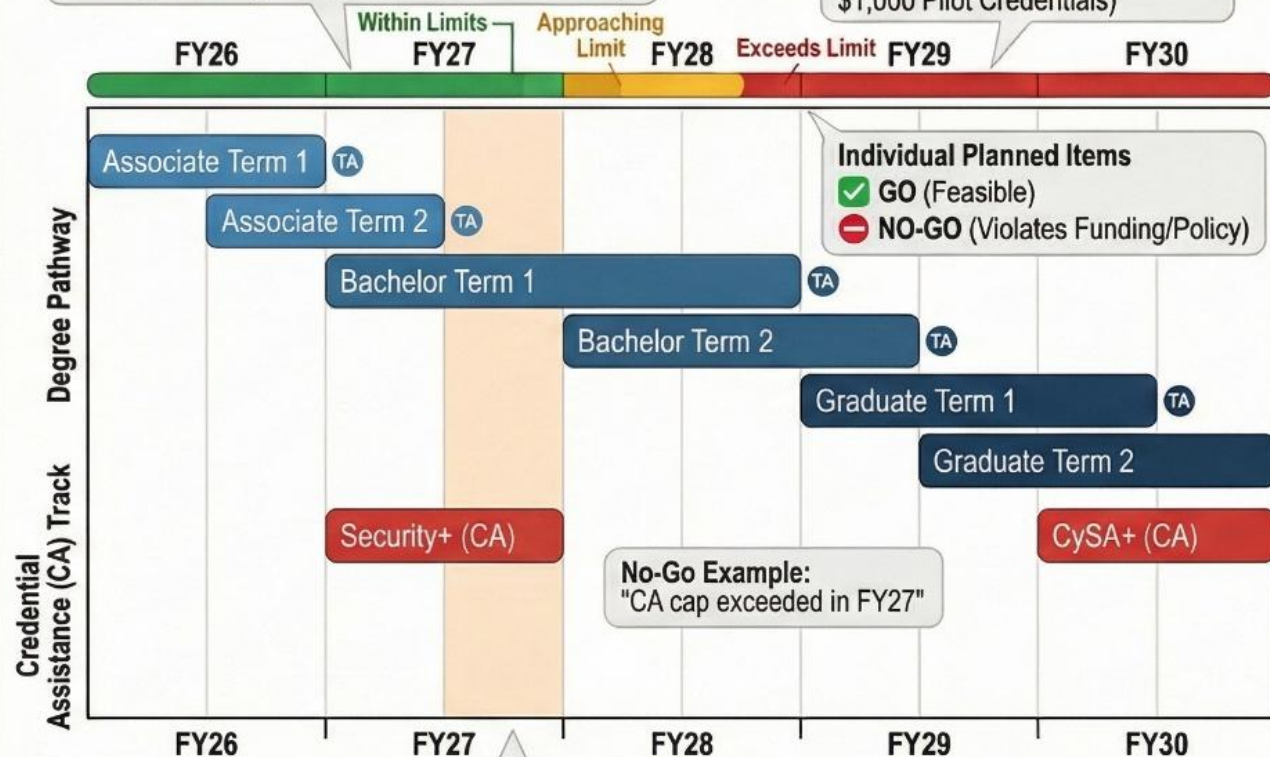
low medium high

**System Responds to VoV Input:** Highlights years with peak financial strain and may suggest alternate sequencing.

## A Multi-Year Gantt Chart for Career Planning

**Funding Rules are Encoded Visually**  
Each fiscal year displays a horizontal funding bar showing consumption against the total annual cap.

**DoD Annual Funding Caps:**  
**\$4,500 Total Annual Cap**  
(\$2,000 Credentialing Assistance, \$1,000 Pilot Credentials)



## Explicit Risk Indicators

- ⌚ **Timing Risk** (compressed planning)
- 💰 **Financial Risk** (out-of-pocket costs)
- ⌛ **Sequencing Risk** (prerequisites missed)
- 🕒 **Wage Delay Risk**

## How It Works: Inputs & Outputs

### Step 1: User Provides Inputs

- 📋 Service Member Profile (MDS, ETS date)
- 🎯 Career Goals
- 📅 Planned Education & Credentialing Timeline

### Step 2: System Generates Outputs

- 📊 Visual Gantt Chart
- 🚩 Go/No-Go Flags
- 📄 Risk Summary
- 🗣️ Plain-Language Advisory Narration

### Sample Output:

**Advisory Narration:** "This plan exceeds Credentialing Assistance limits in FY27. Resequencing credentials may reduce out-of-pocket costs. No changes are applied automatically."

NotebookLM



# Prescriptive AI with Guardrails

## “Governed Prescriptive AI”

A compliance-grade advisory AI (Prescriptive) that advises but does *not* predict outcomes or automate approvals, while remaining fully transparent and auditable.

## Processes

### AI Mediation Framework

Role: Non-authoritative AI    Function: Translation, Constraint Detection, Pattern Analysis

The AI layer serves as infrastructure—never authority. It performs translation, constraint detection, and pattern analysis while enforcing strict boundaries on autonomous action.

⊗

Hard Constraints (System-Wide)

⊗ No autonomous action

⊗ No individual profiling

⊗ Aggregation only at population level

⊗ Advisory signals only

⊗ No predictive modeling

⊗ No success scoring

PROCESSING STAGES

📄

Stage 1

Input Normalization

Standardize inputs from service member interface into structured formats for analysis. No interpretation or judgment applied.

[View Stage Demo](#)

⚠️

Stage 2

Constraint Analysis

Identify conflicts between stated goals and known constraints. Surface conflicts for human review—never resolve autonomously.

[View Stage Demo](#)

📁

Stage 3

Scenario Construction

Generate hypothetical pathways based on normalized inputs. All scenarios are exploratory and non-binding.

[View Stage Demo](#)

👁️

Stage 4

Explainability Layer

Ensure all AI outputs can be traced to inputs and rules. No black-box processing. Every output must be auditable.

[View Stage Demo](#)

🗣️

Stage 5

Signal Generation

Produce advisory signals for human reviewers. Signals are informational only—never prescriptive or directive.

[View Stage Demo](#)

📋

Stage 6

Aggregation Boundary Check

Ensure population-level aggregation only. No individual profiling permitted. Data aggregation respects privacy boundaries.

[View Stage Demo](#)

↔️

Stage 7

Human Handoff Preparation

Package AI outputs for human review. Surface uncertainty explicitly. Prevent automation bias through design.

[View Stage Demo](#)

➡️

Stage 8

Exit Overview

Clear boundary where AI processing ends and human authority begins. All subsequent decisions are human-made.

[View Stage Demo](#)

📄

View AI Governance Spec Sheet

Architectural Principle

AI in this framework is bounded by design. It cannot recommend, approve, or predict. It can only translate information, detect constraint conflicts, and generate advisory signals for human review. All outputs are explainable, auditable, and non-binding. The moment AI attempts to exceed these boundaries, the system rejects the operation.

Compliant by design, non-p

# The CMGF is a Governed Prescriptive AI

| Concept                                      | AI Theory Term       | CMGF Usage                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Forecasting Outcomes                         | Predictive AI        |  Prohibited        |
| Recommending Actions                         | Prescriptive AI      |  Limited           |
| Policy-Governed, Non-Automated, Auditable AI | Governed Advisory AI |  “Constrained AI” |

## CMGF vs. Predictive Commercial Tools

A comparative analysis highlighting CMGF's strategic advantages

| CHARACTERISTIC        | 🕒 CMGF APPROACH                 | 🤖 PREDICTIVE COMMERCIAL TOOLS  |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Decision Authority    | ✓ 100% Human Authority          | ✗ Automated Recommendations    |
| Predictive Modeling   | ✓ Explicitly Prohibited         | ✗ Core Functionality           |
| Transparency          | ✓ Fully Explainable             | ✗ Black Box Algorithms         |
| Individual Profiling  | ✓ Prohibited                    | ✗ Standard Practice            |
| Compliance Risk       | ✓ Minimal (Compliant by Design) | ✗ High (Requires Retrofitting) |
| Service Member Agency | ✓ Preserved                     | ✗ Potentially Compromised      |
| Audit Trail           | ✓ Complete & Traceable          | ✗ Limited or Proprietary       |
| Scalability           | ✓ Safe & Rapid                  | ✗ Risk Accumulation            |



# How Governing Frameworks Justify CMGF's Non-Predictive Approach

A comprehensive analysis of strategic advantages in high-impact military advising

▼ Filter by Framework

⬆️ Sort

🖥 Full Screen

📄 Export Table

| GOVERNING FRAMEWORK ⬆️                                                                                                                                               | KEY REQUIREMENT / RISK CONCERN ⬆️                                                                                                                                                               | CMGF NON-PREDICTIVE DESIGN CHOICE ⬆️                                                                                                                          | STRATEGIC ADVANTAGE FOR MILITARY ADVISING ⬆️                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  Executive Order 14110 (2023)<br>Safe, Secure, and Trustworthy AI                   | Mandates risk assessments for high-impact AI affecting rights/safety;<br>Prohibits opaque or rights-impacting automated decisions without safeguards.<br>⚠️ High-Impact<br>🛡️ Rights Protection | Explicit prohibition of:<br>✗ Predictive outcome modeling<br>✗ Individual risk scoring<br>✗ Automated approvals<br>✗ Optimization objectives                  | Eliminates exposure to prohibited high-risk practices;<br><br>Ensures full compliance while preserving service-member agency and transition equity.<br>✅ Fully Compliant                    |
|  NIST AI RMF 1.0 (2023) & Generative AI Profile (2024)<br>Trustworthiness Framework | Emphasizes trustworthiness characteristics:<br>✓ Transparent<br>✓ Explainable<br>✓ Fair<br><br>Cautions against bias amplification and lack of human oversight in sociotechnical systems.       | Bounded AI limited to:<br>→ Explainable translation<br>→ Rule-based signals<br>→ De-identified aggregation<br><br>Deliberate non-use of predictive functions. | Transforms ethical restraint into institutional trust;<br><br>Enables safe scaling and explainable outputs that build confidence among ESOs and learners.<br>🏗️ Trust Building   📈 Scalable |
|  GAO Reports (GAO-24-105645 & GAO-24-107332)<br>DoD AI Workforce                  | Highlights DoD gaps in:<br>⚠️ AI workforce management<br>⚠️ Role clarity<br>⚠️ Accountability<br><br>Recommends governed, transparent use over autonomous systems.                              | Human-in-the-loop authority mandatory;<br><br>Aggregate insights for institutional learning without individual profiling.<br>👤 Human Authority Required       | Generates auditable evidence for policy reform (e.g., CA caps);<br><br>Positions CMGF as a readiness multiplier with minimal oversight risk.<br>📄 Auditable   🔄 Readiness Multiplier        |

Compliant by design, non-predictive by default

# Institutional Stewardship

Role: Human Judgment & Accountability    Authority: Human-only decisions

This is a **human workspace**, not an AI workspace. Part C represents formal human decision-making environments including Education Services Offices (ESO), advisors, educators, and administrators. This layer receives AI-mediated signals, performs human judgment, produces official outcomes, and maintains accountability.

## Design Rules

- No predictive language
- Clear role separation
- No automation metaphors
- Decisions explicitly attributed to humans

- Clear role separation
- No predictive language

- Decisions explicitly attributed to humans
- No automation metaphors

Compliant by design, non-predictive by default

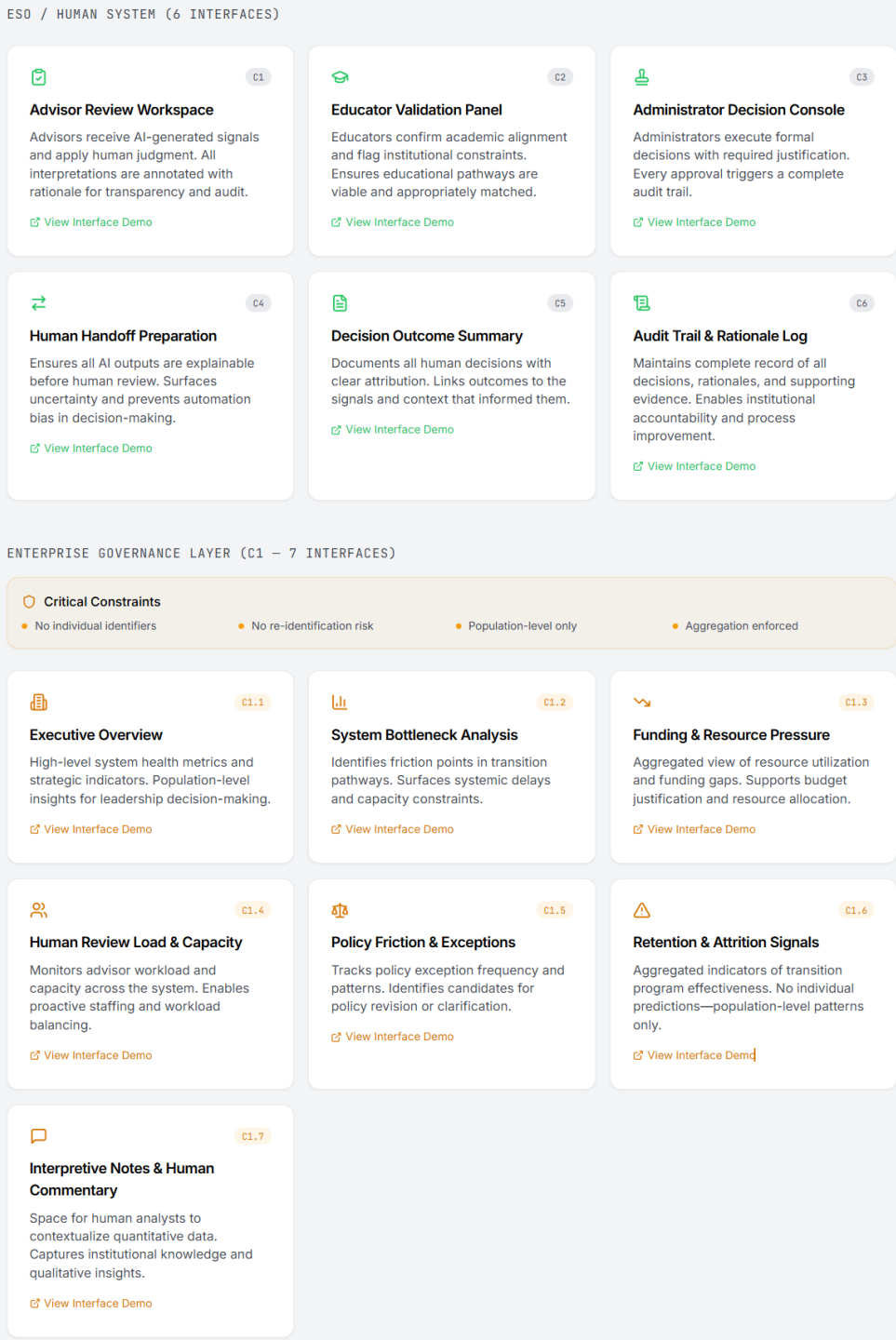
Service Member Facing



DoD Facing



Compliant by design, non-predictive by default



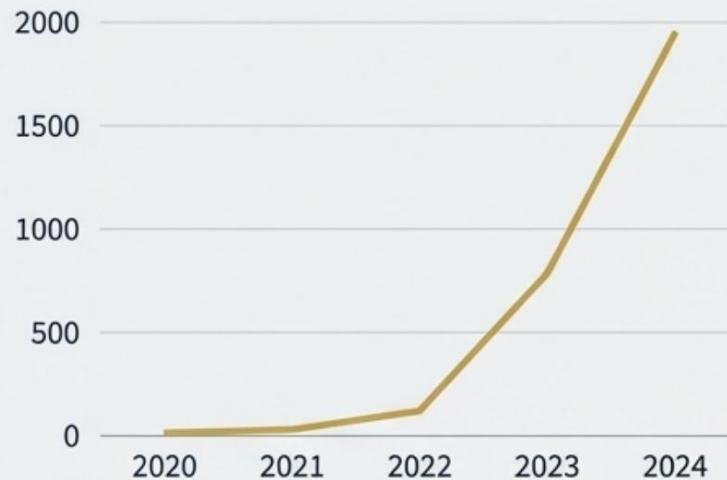


# The Platform Provides Direct, Auditable Evidence to Justify Decisions

## THE ANECDOTE

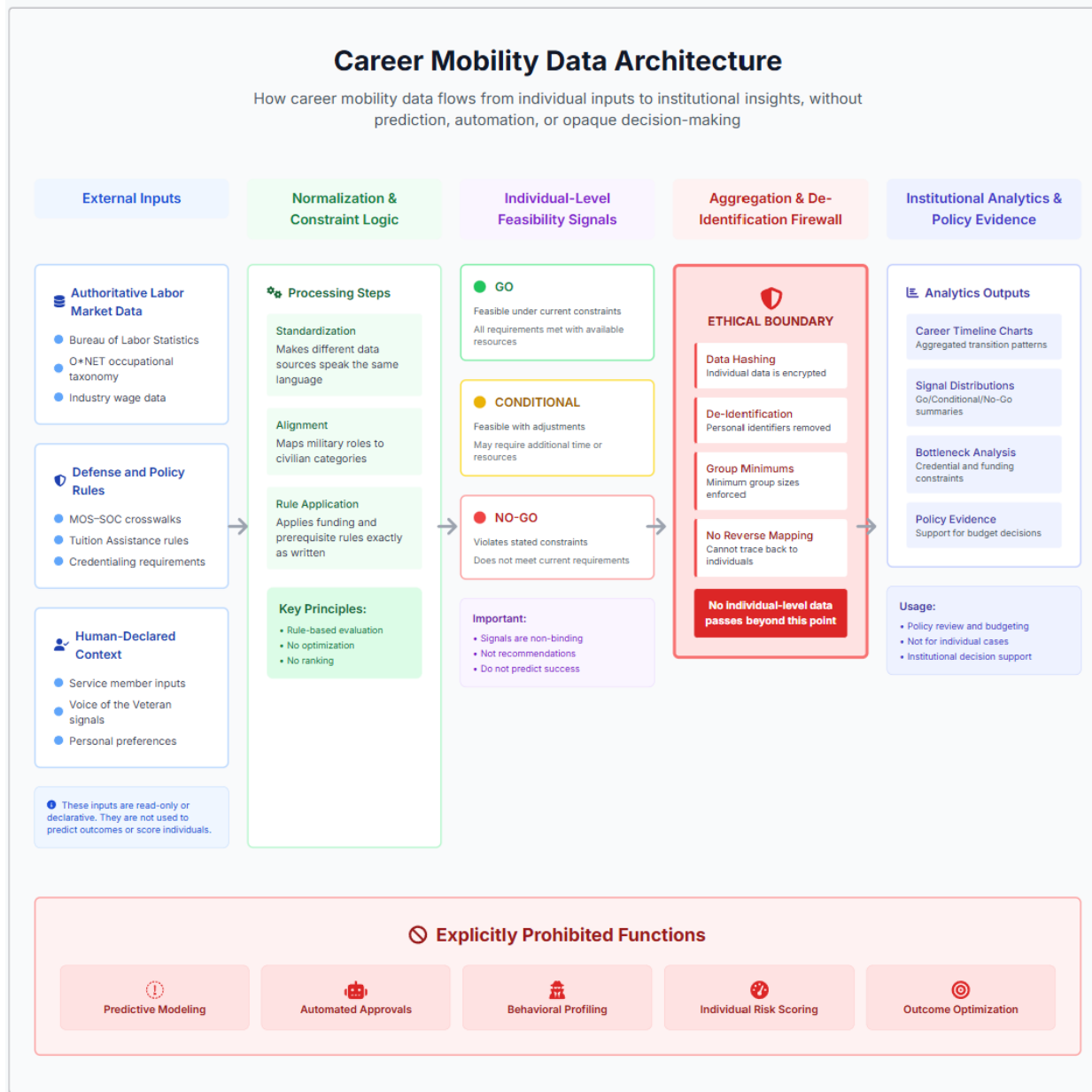
“I’ve heard a lot of soldiers are asking for AI training.”

## AI-Related Requests (YoY)



## THE JUSTIFICATION

SMEPIP data shows a 300% year-over-year increase in AI certification requests, justifying a pilot for a centrally funded, baseline AI training program to meet readiness demands outlined in EO 14110.



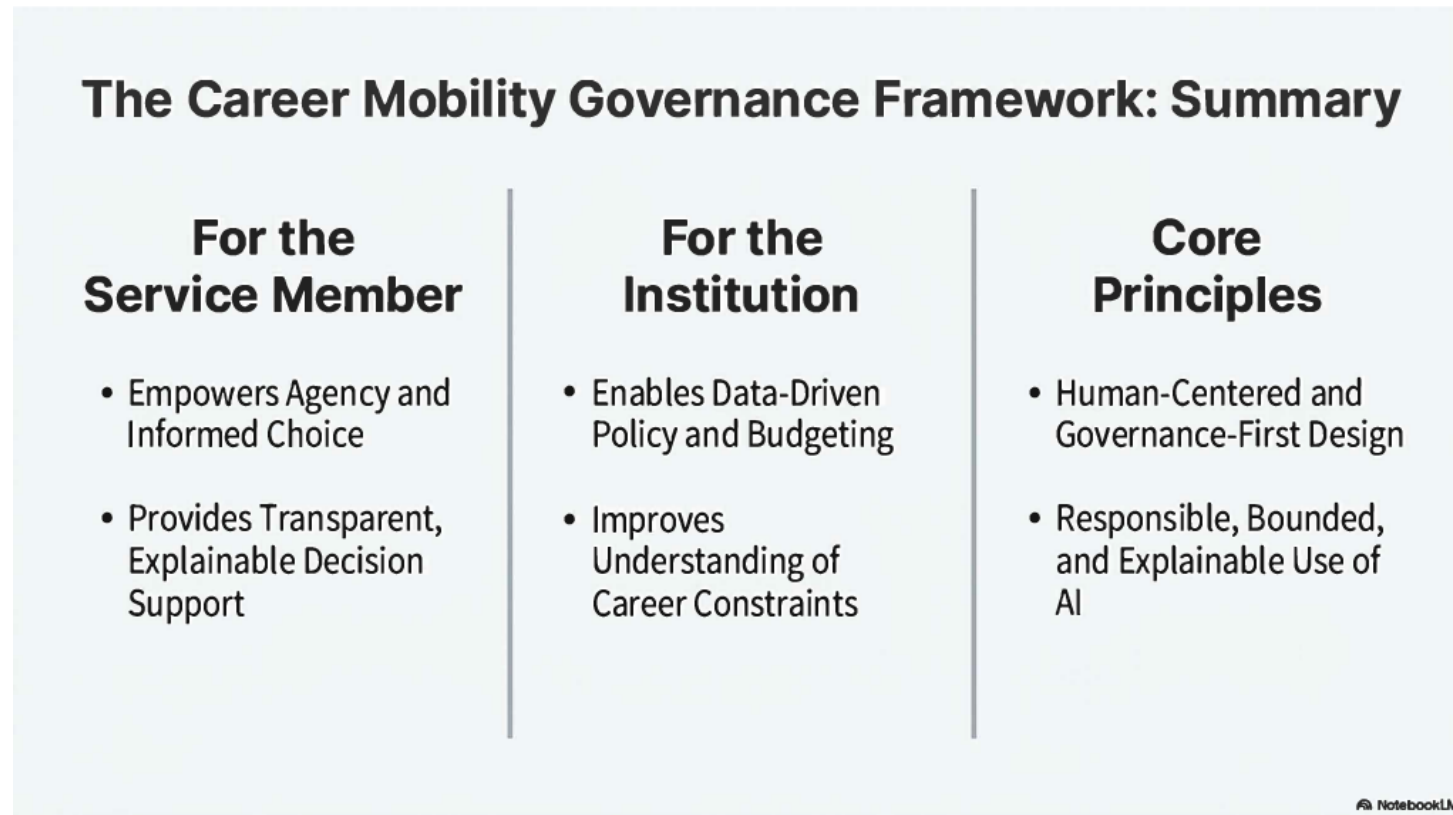
CMGF architecture demonstrates how individual agency and institutional accountability can coexist within a bounded, explainable, non-predictive analytics system.

\*All feasibility signals are traceable to specific policy rules and declared constraints.

Illustrative analytic architecture. Visual elements represent governed data flows and analytic boundaries, not a production user interface.

Compliant by design, non-predictive by default

**This idea needs your partnership to become reality. Let's collaborate to pilot, refine, and deploy governed AI that truly empowers military learners.**



**Compliant by design, non-predictive by default**